



GDD 05

Can-Do Kids

Anyone can be anything

The aspirations game, retrofitted to the mechanic-embodying standard. Children dress up as any job, erase the silly "that's not for you" rules, cheer each other's dreams, sort the chores fairly, and practise "I can be anything". Seven mechanics, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Anyone can be anything.

Can-Do Kids is the aspirations game: children try on every job and discover none of them has a gender. It targets occupational stereotypes at the age they harden, and counters India's "leaky pipeline" (girls top STEM graduation yet vanish from the workforce). This is the v2 retrofit: the v1 library was 71% a single "is this okay?" tap, the same researched truths and 25+ myths now arrive through seven play actions, dress-up-build, erase-the-rule, cheer-aloud, sort, match, choose and reflect.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g05 · can-do-kids (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 1 · ages 3-6 · light canvas · parent co-played
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.2 (anyone can)
Prerequisite / builds on	g04 (Same Same, Different)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS retrofit from v1 (was 71% single-mechanic).

82 scenarios	7 mechanics	23 real-choice moves	27 myths busted	0% binary taps
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Free every dream, both directions.

From the Chapter 1 personas. The game frees girls toward "things" jobs and boys toward "people" jobs, both directions matter, and each persona's magic points at a v2 mechanic.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Aria, 5	To believe STEM, leading and building are for her.	strike-rewrite + role-play : erase "girls can't", cheer it.
"Faizan"-type	To know caring/arts jobs are great for boys.	strike-rewrite + branch : boys as nurses, chefs, dancers.
Kabir, 5 (first-gen)	To dream a job no one in the family has done.	branch + reflect : "be the first"; believers.
Vihaan, 4	To see failing as part of learning.	branch + role-play : "I can't... YET", try again.
Sunita (joint family)	Fairness "dadi nods along to".	sort + build : "everyone helps the family".

Why this works (the evidence). Children draw scientists gender-equally at 5-6 but skew male by 7-8: occupational stereotypes set early, so 3-6 is the window. Counter-stereotypical role models (women in STEM, men in care) raise children's interest and ability beliefs, this game is that exposure, made playable.

Seven moves, one truth.

The rework's heart: the truth "anyone can be anything" arrives through seven actions, each one being the lesson, instead of one repeated tap. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite	Erases an occupational myth ("girls can't be pilots"), writes the truth.	Conceptual change, the game's core.	27
branch	Chooses in a real moment (a teased dream, an unfair chore), sees what happens.	Decisions; standing up.	12
match	Pairs any kid to any job / role model / tool.	Breaking false job-gender links.	11
role-play (voice)	Says it aloud ("I can be anything!"; cheers a friend).	Self-efficacy; audio-first.	11
reflect	Names their own dream (no wrong answer).	Autonomy; aspiration.	10
build (dress-up)	Tries on a job's outfit; builds a Career Day / fair chore chart.	"I can be that"; possibility.	9
sort	Sorts chores/jobs into "anyone can" vs "silly rule".	Fair vs unfair.	2

23 of 82 moments are branch or role-play; binary "tap the right answer": **0%**. Strike-rewrite leads because busting the occupational myths is this game's job.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Dress-up is a beloved 3-6 pattern: try on a pilot's cap, a chef's hat, a space helmet, see yourself in the role, and hear "you can be that!". Then erase a silly rule and watch it vanish, cheer a friend's dream aloud, build a Career Day. Every screen is a new little action, the antidote to "solved the pattern, now just clicking".

Is it teaching?

Yes, occupational counter-stereotyping at the age it counts, plus a growth-mindset thread (ability grows with practice; failing is learning) and fair-share-the-chores. The child rehearses "anyone can be anything", and meets women in STEM and men in care, the role models the research says shift beliefs.

The belief it moves. From "girls can't be pilots/engineers; boys can't be nurses/dancers; girls aren't good at maths; chores are girls' work; you're born good or not" → "any job is for anyone, ability grows with practice, everyone helps at home, and no dream is off-limits because of my gender."

Same truths, new actions.

82 scenarios across six categories, India-grounded (women pilots/scientists, men nurses/chefs, the "coding isn't for girls" myth, joint-family chores) and growth-mindset-aware. Every one re-encoded to a typed v2 mechanic.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Anyone can be it	14	build, match, strike-rewrite	Doctor, pilot, chef, scientist, firefighter, astronaut, engineer.
Girls can do "men's" jobs	12	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Pilot, engineer, coder, scientist, leader, defence; "maths isn't too hard".
Boys can do "caring/arts" jobs	12	strike-rewrite, branch, match	Nurse, dancer, chef, carer, teacher; stay-at-home dad.
Home jobs are for everyone	10	sort, branch, build	Cook, fix, clean, baby-care; "everyone helps the family".
Dream big; ability grows	14	reflect, branch, strike-rewrite	Be the first; practice over "born with it"; failing is learning.
No one decides your dream by gender	14	strike-rewrite, match, reflect	Old ideas vs rules; role models; career AND family.

A branch scenario (real choice), verbatim.

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hook: "A girl says she'll be an engineer, and a kid laughs."
option A "Say 'girls are great engineers, go for it!'" -> she stands tall, keeps her dream [best]
option B "Laugh too" -> she shrinks from a dream she'd love
debrief: "A quick cheer can save a big dream."
relearn: "Back a girl's big dream; don't laugh it away."
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Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 05 Can-Do Kids — Scenario Library.json](#) (82 records, v2 schema).

What this game erases.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Girls can't be pilots / engineers / scientists.	Women do all of these; girls build and fly.	Counter-stereotype; India STEM gap.
Boys can't be nurses / dancers / cooks.	Caring and arts jobs are wonderful for boys.	Care-work research.
Doctors are men; nurses are women.	Anyone can be either.	Occupational stereotypes.
Girls aren't good at maths / coding.	Ability grows with practice, not gender.	Ability-belief research.
Kitchen and cleaning are girls' work.	Everyone helps the family, by turns.	Gender-equal caregiving.
You're born good at it or you're not.	Skills grow with effort; failing is learning.	Growth-mindset research.
You can't be the first in your family.	You can be the first; someone always is.	Aspiration / social mobility.
Your gender decides your job.	No dream is off-limits because of gender.	Occupational stereotypes.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy holds up an outfit: "ooh, who could wear this?".
2. **Play.** One of seven mechanics, rotated, never the same twice in a row.
3. **Cheer.** Trying on a role or building a Career Day makes the canvas celebrate.
4. **UN → RE moment.** On a myth, UN erases it and RE writes the truth ("girls can't be pilots" → "women fly planes").
5. **Apply.** Say "I can be anything", cheer a friend, or sort the chores fairly.
6. **Sticker.** The "anyone can" badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surfaces: the **dress-up mirror** (a child sees themselves in any role), brief **role-model cameos** (a woman pilot, a man nurse), and **say-it-aloud** voice beats. Co-play prompts invite the grown-up to share their own job and dreams.

Open every door, kindly.

- **Register.** Ages 3-6: aspirational, joyful, never preachy; "you can be that!" is the feeling.
- **Both directions.** Girls into STEM/leadership AND boys into care/arts; neither gender is the "problem".
- **Growth mindset, not pressure.** Effort and practice over innate talent; failing framed as learning; no ranking.
- **Don't villainise.** Traditional roles aren't mocked; the point is more doors, not fewer (Sunita's "dadi nods along").
- **Safe to be wrong.** No buzzer; reflects have no wrong answer.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline, low-data, colour never the only signal; India role models, names and jobs; co-play.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. can-do-kids** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** Each scenario carries type + typed payload (build.pieces, strike-rewrite.myth, branch.options, match.pairs, role-play.yourLine, sort.items/bins/key, reflect.options). Reuses the shared templates from g09/g04.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, max 33%, 0% binary, 23 autonomy, 27 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Asset need.** The dress-up verb needs a job-outfit set (20+ professions) with gender-varied role-model art.
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): no hard fail; open doors both ways; growth-mindset not talent-pressure; don't villainise; represent every child; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Stereotypes set early.** The Draw-A-Scientist research finds children draw scientists gender-equally at 5-6 but skew male by 7-8; occupational stereotypes are learnt before kids can question them, so 3-6 is the window.
- **Role models work.** Exposure to counter-stereotypical role models (e.g., women in STEM, men in care) raises children's interest, ability beliefs and aspirations, this game is that exposure, made playable.
- **India's leaky pipeline.** Women are ~43% of India's STEM graduates but only ~27% of the STEM workforce, held back by stereotypes ("coding isn't for girls") and care burdens; care work is heavily feminised, so boys-in-care matters too.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. Retrofit 2 of 9 (g01-08, g37) to the v2 standard; worst-offenders first. g05 was 71% single-mechanic and is now scorecard-clean.